

Basic bidding Notrump raises Major suit raises

This set of practice deals focuses on basic bidding situations. There are no conventions used except for one deal which uses Blackwood. Even that is optional.

The deals are designed with the beginning player in mind, or perhaps those who feel the need to refresh themselves on the fundamentals of bidding.

The purpose of these deals is to provide practice in finding a fit and deciding whether to stop at a part score, bid game or bid slam.

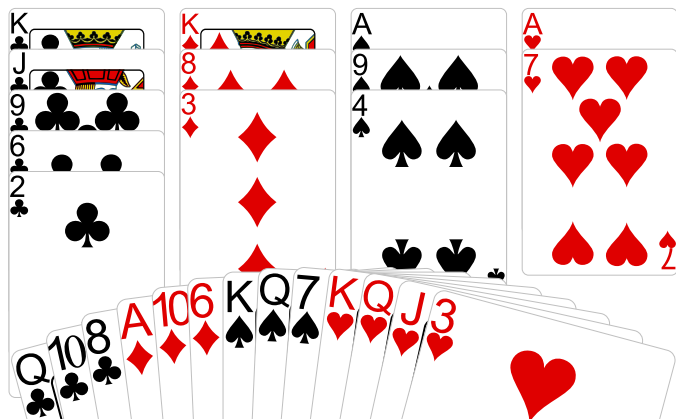
Keep in mind:

- a combined 8-card trump fit is desired to play in a suit

- it takes 26 points to make game in Notrump or a Major suit

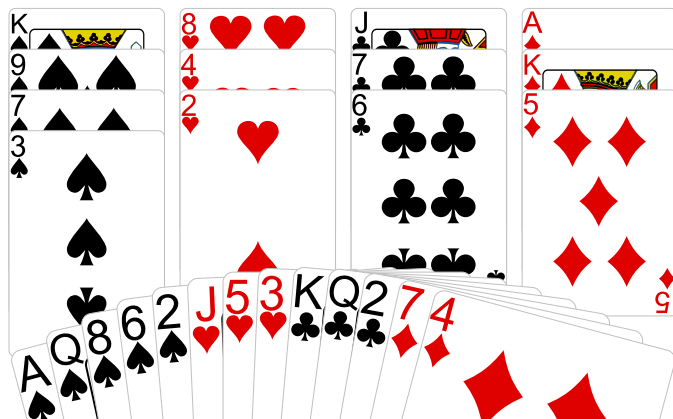
- it takes 33 points to make small slam

Deal 1 Ctr: 6NT Goal: at least ____ winners



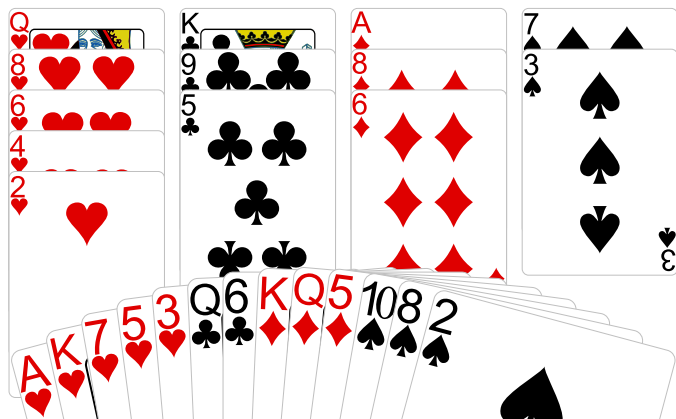
Count Sure Winners				
♠	♥	♦	♣	Total
Decide How to Develop Winners				
Promotion	Length	Finesse	End Play	

Deal 2 Ctr: 3♠ Goal: at most ____ losers



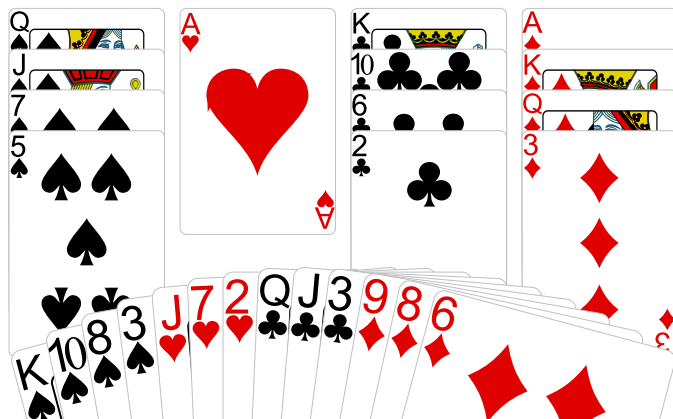
Count Fast and Slow Losers				
♠	♥	♦	♣	Total
Decide How to Reduce Losers				
Ruffs	Finesse	Pitch	Length	

Deal 3 Ctr: 4♥ Goal: at most ____ losers



Count Fast and Slow Losers				
♠	♥	♦	♣	Total
Decide How to Reduce Losers				
Ruffs	Finesse	Pitch	Length	

Deal 4 Ctr: 4♠ Goal: at most ____ losers



Count Fast and Slow Losers				
♠	♥	♦	♣	Total
Decide How to Reduce Losers				
Ruffs	Finesse	Pitch	Length	

Board: 1
Dealer: **North**
Contract: 6NT
Declarer: North

Board: 2
Dealer: **West**
Contract: 3♠
Declarer: East

Board: 3
Dealer: **South**
Contract: 4♥
Declarer: South

Board: 4
Dealer: **East**
Contract: 4♠
Declarer: West

Board: 5
Dealer: **North**
Contract: 4♠
Declarer: North

Deal 1

North Deals
None Vul

♠ T 8 3 2
♥ T 9
♦ Q J 9 7 2
♣ 7 5

17
3 5
15

♠ K Q 7
♥ K Q J 3
♦ A T 6
♣ Q T 8



♠ A 9 4
♥ A 7
♦ K 8 3
♣ K J 9 6 2

♠ J 6 5
♥ 8 6 5 4 2
♦ 5 4
♣ A 4 3

West	North	East	South
	1NT	Pass	4NT
Pass	6NT		
All Pass			
6NT by North			

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NORTH has a maximum 17 point 1NT bid.

SOUTH, with 16 points, can't tell if there are enough points for slam. If NORTH has

17 points then a slam should be makeable, but if NORTH has only 15 points then he

should settle for game.

The 4NT raise solves the problem. It tells NORTH to bid 6NT with 17 points, pass

with 15 points, and use best judgment with 16. Here NORTH bids the slam.

Deal 2

West Deals
N-S Vul

♠ K 9 7 3
♥ 8 4 2
♦ A K 5
♣ J 7 6

7
11 12
10

♠ J T 5
♥ K T 7 6
♦ Q J 3
♣ T 4 3



♠ 4
♥ A Q 9
♦ T 9 8 6 2
♣ A 9 8 5

♠ A Q 8 6 2
♥ J 5 3
♦ 7 4
♣ K Q 2

West	North	East	South
Pass	Pass	1 ♠	Pass
3 ♠			
All Pass			
3 ♠ by East			

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WEST has just 11 points, not enough to open the bidding.

But when EAST opens 1 ♠ WEST should show her "almost opening strength"

by jumping to 3 ♠.

EAST has just 13 points, and knowing WEST has less than 13 he passes.

Deal 3

South Deals
None Vul

♠ 5
♥ J T 9
♦ J T 9 7 4
♣ A J 7 3

9
7 10
14

♠ 7 3
♥ Q 8 6 4 2
♦ A 8 6
♣ K 9 5

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ T 8 2
♥ A K 7 5 3
♦ K Q 5
♣ Q 6

♠ A K Q J 9 6 4
♥ -
♦ 3 2
♣ T 8 4 2

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After SOUTH opens with 1



, NORTH has a small "dilemma".

With 11 points she really is only strong enough
to make a jump raise to 3



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West	North	East	South
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Pass
All Pass
4♥ by South

1♥

But, with five trumps the hand deserves more.
So she just bids 4



instead.

Usually, no matter what your strength, when you have five cards in the Major suit that your
partner opens

with you should just jump right to game.

Deal 4

East Deals

Both Vul

♠ K T 8 3
 ♥ J 7 2
 ♦ 9 8 6
 ♣ Q J 3

6
 7 19
 8

♠ A 9 6 4

♥ Q T 8 3

♦ T 4 2

♣ 7 5



♠ 2

♥ K 9 6 5 4

♦ J 7 5

♣ A 9 8 4

♠ Q J 7 5

♥ A

♦ A K Q 3

♣ K T 6 2

West

North

East

South

1 ♠

Pass

1 ♦

Pass

All Pass

4 ♠ by West
 game.

She bids 4 ♠.

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EAST has 19 points, but no 5-card Major suit.

With two 4-card minor suits she should start

with 1

♦

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WEST has a poor hand, but with 7 points he
 must respond. His first priority is to show a
 Major suit

so he responds 1 ♠.

EAST now knows that ♠s will be trumps, so
 she revalues her hand to 21 points, enough for

Deal 5

North Deals
N-S Vul

♠ A
♥ J 9 8
♦ T 9 5 4
♣ Q J T 5 2

16
8 7
9

♠ K Q J 7 4
♥ K Q 2
♦ A J 6
♣ 9 3



♠ T 9 6 3
♥ 7 5 4
♦ Q 7
♣ A K 6 4

♠ 8 5 2
♥ A T 6 3
♦ K 8 3 2
♣ 8 7

West	North	East	South
	1 ♠	Pass	2 ♠
Pass	3 ♠	Pass	4 ♠
All Pass			
4 ♠ by North			

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NOTE: There is a better way to bid this hand using special conventions.

NORTH has 17 points, but with a 5-card Major opens 1 ♠ rather than 1NT.

SOUTH isn't quite strong enough for a jump raise, so she bids 2 ♠.

NORTH has enough extra to make a try for game, so she invites with 3 ♠.

SOUTH has enough extra to accept the invitation, bids 4 ♠.